

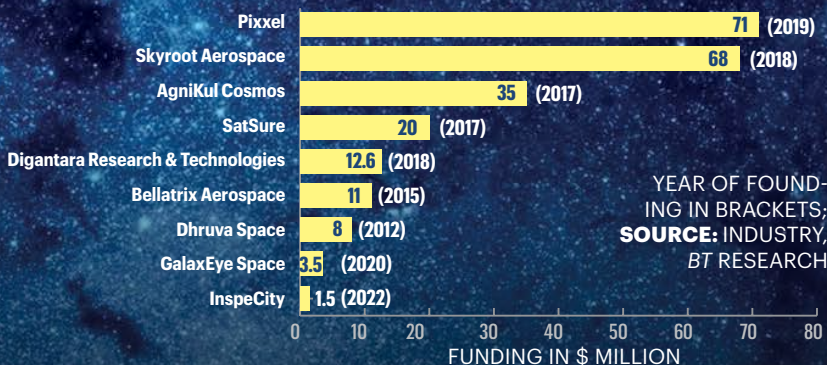
ment Corp. Ltd, and Mishra Dhatu Nigam Ltd. It also has storied names from the private sector like Tata Consulting Engineers (TCE)—part of the N. Chandrasekaran-led Tata group—whose relationship with Isro dates to 1971, when it engineered the first solid propellant plant. Today, the TCE-designed mobile launch pedestal at the Satish Dhawan Space Centre is used for assembling satellite launch vehicles.

“Private sector participation plays a crucial role in India’s success in the space sector. It brings in much-needed innovation for developing space-based applications and services while also opening a new pool of resources and talent,” says Amit Sharma, MD and CEO of Tata Consulting Engineers.

28 | Likewise, Jamshyd Godrej-led Godrej & Boyce has been an Isro partner for over 30 years, contributing to the production of over 175 engines for the agency’s workhorse Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle (PSLV) and Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle (GSLV) missions through its subsidiary, Godrej Aerospace. “We have been partnering with Isro’s space missions, including all PSLV and GSLV missions, and have contributed critical components like liquid propulsion engines, satellite thrusters, and control module components for both the Chandrayaan and Mangalyaan missions,” says Maneck Behramkamdin, Associate Vice President and Business Head at Godrej Aerospace.

Engineering-to-IT conglomerate Larsen & Toubro, led by S.N. Subrahmanyam, is another storied partner. The critical aerodynamic test facilities it developed in 1975 are not only among India’s first but have few precedents worldwide. “L&T has played a critical role in the launch of the Launch Vehicle Mark-

THE INDIAN FUNDING STORY



► Indian start-ups have raised over \$230 million since inception

► Pixxel, founded in 2019, has raised the highest amount at \$71 million

GLOBAL FUNDING SPREE

★ Spacetechn start-ups received over \$15 billion in investments in 2021 in 241 deals

★ The total global investments for space start-ups grew 2x from \$7.7 billion in 2020 to \$15.4 billion in 2021

★ The average deal size for spacetechn start-ups rose by 35 per cent to \$64 million in 2021

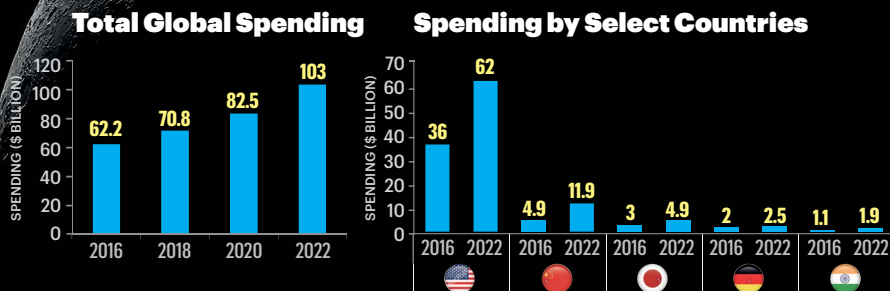
★ Since 2000, VCs have invested \$27 billion in spacetechn start-ups

★ 69 per cent of investments in 596 deals in 2021 were contributed by VC firms

★ A record 13 space start-up acquisitions occurred in 2021, up from 11 in 2020

SOURCE EUROCONSULT, ARTHUR D. LITTLE

INCREASING SPENDS



► Worldwide, government spending on space programmes has increased significantly

► The spending has been growing at a CAGR of nearly 8.8 per cent since 2016

SOURCE EUROCONSULT, ARTHUR D. LITTLE

GRAPHICS BY RAHUL SHARMA